

**Before the
FEDERAL COMMUNICATIONS COMMISSION
Washington, DC 20554**

In the Matter of	)	
	)	
	)	
Facilitating Implementation of Next	)	PS Docket No. 21-479
Generation 911 Services (NG911)	)	
	)	
Massachusetts State 911 Department	)	PS Docket No. 25-143
Request of April 4, 2025	)	

VERIZON REPLY TO COMMENTS AND OPPOSITIONS

I. INTRODUCTION

Comments responding to Verizon’s Petition for Waiver (the “Petition”) illustrate the multiple policy considerations and technical realities the Commission sought to navigate in its 2024 Order. Public safety commenters understandably want to minimize unnecessary delays in NG911 implementation.¹ Originating service providers (OSPs) understandably want to avoid situations in which deployment challenges, including resolving inconsistent SIP methods, leave it with no choice other than a waiver petition.² And all parties want to minimize disputes and initiate NG911 for their customers and residents as soon as feasibly possible. The Petition shows that flexibility by 911 Authorities, coupled with OSPs’ diligent, good faith efforts and demonstrable progress toward Phase 1 implementation, best achieves these objectives.³

¹ See Massachusetts State 911 Dept. Comments at 6-9; Joint Texas 9-1-1 Districts Opposition at 3-4; South Carolina Revenue and Fiscal Affairs Office Comments, at 1-2.

² See CTIA Comments at 1-2; USTelecom Comments at 2-3.

³ Verizon here primarily focuses on commenters’ concerns for *wireline* Phase 1 implementation. Massachusetts “agrees that Verizon Wireless has obtained Phase 1 compliance,” and wireless Phase 1 implementation is already at various implementation and NGCS coordination stages with the Texas 911 Districts and South Carolina RFA.

II. MASSACHUSETTS' CONCERNS FOR VERIZON'S WIRELINE PHASE 1 DEPLOYMENT WARRANT CLARIFICATION.

Verizon appreciates the Commonwealth's continued engagement and collaboration. Just last week, the Commonwealth agreed to help identify MLTS entities that currently provide PS/ALI data to its ALI Database, in order to facilitate our efforts to inform enterprises affected by Phase 1 implementation.⁴ Its comments raise some issues, however, that warrant clarification to ensure an accurate record.

A. Verizon Is Addressing MLTS Impact in a Manner that Will Not Adversely Affect Phase 1 and Phase 2 Reliability and Deployment.

The Commonwealth recognizes the public interest in facilitating MLTS entities' compliance with their 911 obligations.⁵ Several clarifications concerning the challenges of addressing the MLTS issue, however, are warranted. First, the assertion that "Verizon made the business choice not to provide the [PS/ALI] service" is incorrect.⁶ Starting in 2012, when the Commonwealth's vendor (General Dynamics at the time) took responsibility as the 911 service provider, Verizon's legacy wireline business no longer controlled the ALI database in which PS/ALI records are maintained. As such, Verizon has had no ability to offer the PS/ALI service that was under the control of the Commonwealth's ALI database vendor. Relatedly, the extent to which "Verizon customers must use a third party for connectivity" is a function of their own

⁴ After the Commonwealth's NGCS vendor took over ALI database responsibilities from Verizon's regulated telephone company in 2012 it was no longer necessary to track Verizon legacy dial tone customers' PS/ALI use. In any event, Verizon provided clear guidance that could be shared with the Commonwealth's known PS/ALI users as part of our outreach program (and that was provided to Bureau staff), and the stated concern that Verizon "has not been clear as to what information" the Commonwealth could provide to MLTS users appears largely moot. Massachusetts Comments at 9.

⁵ Massachusetts Comments at 5.

⁶ *Id.* at 7.

business requirements; soft phone users, for example, may use a third party VPC to address those needs, but other dialtone customers with only fixed devices may either provide Verizon with station level location data or use a PS/ALI database to meet their obligations.

In addition, the Commonwealth’s description of how 911 calls from MLTS PS/ALI users connect 911 calls to the NGCS provider is not universal.⁷ During the January First Office Application (FOA) discussed in the Petition, calls routing to the ECRC traveled from the customer to the Verizon End Office, then to a Verizon tandem (the former Selective Router), and finally to Intrado where the absence of the caller’s location data caused the call to route to the ECRC. Also, the statement “MLTS owner operators must configure their MLTS to dial a ten-digit number in order to ‘connect to 911’” is incorrect.⁸ No Verizon dialtone customer must configure its MLTS to dial anything other than 911 and pass 911 as the called party number.

Additionally, Verizon has no “continued reliance on PS/ALI providers” per se.⁹ MLTS entities themselves are responsible for RAY BAUM’S Act compliance. A legacy TDM-based MLTS cannot generate PIDF-LO for call routing or location delivery purposes. Additionally, no Commission rules require a MLTS entity to provision location data to its dial tone provider.¹⁰ It is this gap—with Phase 1 *and* 2 implications—that Verizon’s Massachusetts Phase 1 deployment revealed. And Verizon customers with an IP-based MLTS solution capable of generating

⁷ *Id.* at 7.

⁸ *Id.* at 7.

⁹ *Id.* at 8. That some MLTS entities may not fully comply with the Commission’s rules is unrelated to Verizon’s Petition.

¹⁰ “Presence Information Data Format-Location Object” or “PIDF-LO” is the format used to deliver caller location information over IP-based networks by attaching the location information directly to the SIP format.

PIDF-LO, such as Microsoft Teams, typically use third party vendors such as Bandwidth, Comtech, Redsky and or Sinch for 911 call routing and delivery, not PS/ALI.

Finally, Verizon does not ask the Commonwealth to compel all Verizon’s PS/ALI users to “switch to Verizon’s preferred vendor.”¹¹ Whether an MLTS uses PS/ALI will depend on the MLTS product procured for the enterprise. Once a plan for PS/ALI users was developed and initiated, Verizon requested that MLTS users provide Verizon with PS/ALI location data using a simple spreadsheet sent to psaliupdate@verizon.com, at no cost to them in order to support Phase 1 and Phase 2 compliance.

B. The Commonwealth Understates the Significance of the Deployment Challenges and Verizon’s Progress Addressing Them.

At the outset, Verizon agrees that Massachusetts does not impose a preferred aggregator into an OSP’s NG911 configuration.¹² But the “preferred traffic aggregator” referenced in the Petition relates to the aggregator directly supporting the Commonwealth’s NGCS provider, not Verizon’s own aggregator.¹³ This distinction is important. As the Petition explains, Phase 1 deployment is not an “off the shelf” turnkey product or process. Each NGCS provider maintains its own systems and SIP methods, and initial deployments with a particular NGCS configuration predictably run into challenges—as was the case in Massachusetts.¹⁴

Wireless Phase 1. The Commonwealth acknowledges that wireless Phase 1 is met,¹⁵ but suggests the additional deployment time could have been avoided with direct connection to the

¹¹ *Id.* at 9.

¹² *Id.* at 4.

¹³ Petition at 6.

¹⁴ *See id.* at 4-7.

¹⁵ Massachusetts Comments at 8.

in-state points of interconnection (POIs). That approach, however, would have entailed the procurement and deployment of new circuit connections, and testing of new SIP connections between Verizon and the Commonwealth's ESInet provider (as those POIs were configured at the time). Verizon's prior experience with initial wireless Phase 1 deployments involving other SIP-capable NGCS providers indicated that these steps would take several months longer than employing alternative national POIs. By leveraging alternate POIs and vendor relationships already in place, Verizon believes it was able to initiate Phase 1 deployment more expeditiously than if compelled to connect directly to the in-state POIs.¹⁶ Verizon is also making significant progress with wireless Phase 2 implementation—due in large part to having deployed Phase 1 in this manner.¹⁷

Wireline Phase 1. For wireline, the Petition explains (and the Commonwealth does not dispute) the extent of Verizon's Phase 1 implementation, and the significance and success of the FOA testing. While the State expresses concern for the timing of Phase 2 implementation, it likewise does not meaningfully dispute that Verizon's approach will facilitate both Phase 1 *and* Phase 2 deployment. Indeed, Verizon expects that even with a late 2026 launch date, wireline Phase 2 implementation in Massachusetts will occur months (if not years) before much of the remainder of the country.¹⁸

¹⁶ As noted in the Petition, the Commonwealth agreed to extend another wireless provider's implementation date to March 31, 2026. Petition at 9.

¹⁷ Verizon has requested a preliminary extension of wireless Phase 2 through June 30, 2026 as a placeholder until a more definitive implementation schedule can be worked out with the Commonwealth's NGCS vendor. Verizon is hopeful for a target date sometime in 3Q2026—which, as with wireline, would result in Phase 2 implementation well in advance of much of the rest of the country.

¹⁸ The purported shortcomings of Intrado's solution reflect the intrinsic limitations of many MLTS products and are unrelated to Phase 1 or 2 compliance. For example, that "[t]he static PS/ALI solution proposed has not been shown to be capable of dealing with non-fixed locations" is not relevant, as the solution is not intended to address that scenario. Massachusetts Comments

III. VERIZON IS DILIGENTLY IMPLEMENTING PHASE 1 ACROSS TEXAS.

The commenting 911 districts, together with many others in Texas, have all been good partners, and Verizon is either delivering Phase 1, deploying Phase 1, or actively engaging with NGCS vendors to resolve technical challenges relating, again, to the initial launch of a particular NGCS configuration.¹⁹ To clarify, though, Verizon seeks targeted, temporary relief, not a “blanket” extension of the Phase 1 deadline. Indeed, the application of the Petition to the 911 Districts underscores the targeted nature of the request.²⁰

NCT is covered by the June 30, 2026 date of the request for wireline Phase 1, a limited three month extension beyond the mutually agreed-to date of March 30, 2026.²¹ For the commenting jurisdictions, wireless Phase 1 is complete for Cameron County and Rio Grande Valley, and implementation is underway for NCT’s jurisdictions and on track to meet the agreed-to May 31, 2026 date there. For wireline Phase 1, Cameron and Rio Grande Valley’s requests are not covered by the Petition as they have agreed to a July 31, 2026 implementation date.²² While the Petition applies to Brazos’s request, there is only a 10-day difference between the 6-month date and the July 31, 2026 date of the request. And Tarrant County’s February 1,

at 8. Rather, there are other products on the market that do not require a third party solution. In any case, Intrado’s status under the state’s MLTS regulations, *see id.* at 7-8, is immaterial to the merits of Verizon’s Petition.

¹⁹ Comments filed by the South Carolina Revenue and Fiscal Affairs Office appear focused primarily on other parties’ previously-filed *ex parte* presentation. *See* South Carolina RFA Comments, at 1-2. Verizon and the state have nonetheless mutually agreed to a May 31, 2026 extension for wireless Phase 1, and wireline Phase 1 would be covered by the Petition’s provision for a July 31, 2026 date.

²⁰ Verizon’s Petition does not cover its Frontier wireline subsidiaries with service in these jurisdictions, but we note that Frontier has initiated Phase 1 in all or part of two of those jurisdictions and continues to engage constructively with all those 911 Authorities in Phase 1 implementation.

²¹ *See* Verizon Letter in PS Docket No. 25-145 (Dec. 19, 2025).

²² *See* Petition at 10.

2026 request is not covered by the Petition in the first instance, for either wireless or wireline Phase 1.²³

In short, Verizon's Phase 1 status for the Texas 911 Districts reflects that, as elsewhere in the country, the company timely deploys Phase 1 when feasible and, in all cases, works diligently with 911 Authorities and their NGCS providers to resolve technical challenges that arise with new NGCS configurations.

IV. CONCLUSION

For these reasons and those described in Verizon's Petition, the Commission should grant Verizon the temporary, targeted Phase 1 relief requested in order to preserve OSPs' and 911 Authorities' incentives to reach mutually agreed deployment timetables and account for the technical realities of NG911 implementation, consistent with the Commission's objective of promoting the transition to NG911.

Respectfully submitted,

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²³ Verizon notes that Tarrant County and other Texas jurisdictions use an NGCS configuration that raises initial wireless Phase 1 onboarding challenges similar to those we faced in Massachusetts. We are working with the NGCS provider on a solution that will enable us to deploy Phase 1 and have begun engaging with the affected 911 Authorities (in Texas and elsewhere) to inform them of the challenges and work through an implementation schedule.